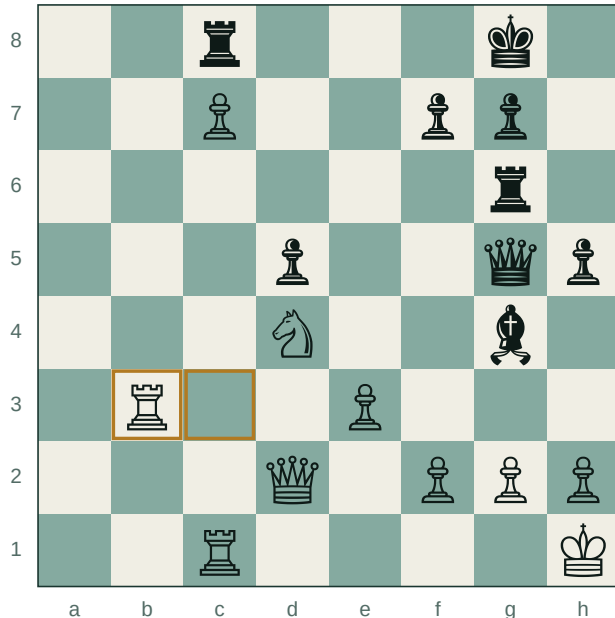


Mate in three: Black, move 28

Mate in three

Black to move



Previous move: 28.Rb3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28...Bf3 29. Rg1 Bxg2+ 30. Rxg2 Qxg2#

28...Bf3 The bishop moves from g4 to f3. Recorded reply: **29.Rg1**.

29...Bxg2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on g2. Recorded reply: **30.Rxg2**.

30...Qxg2# Mate: queen on g2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on g2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not stop at a promising check. The final mating position must still be legal after every intervening move.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Longer mating lines require accurate visualization. Track the king's square, opened lines, and every sacrificed piece through the entire sequence.

HOW TO LOOK

Work backward from a mating pattern, then calculate forward with the opponent choosing the strongest defense.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: queen on d2. Check for tactical protection.